

Hey Rohan, good speaking with you today. Your question about Andrew Ng vs. Scaler was the sharpest one I heard all week -- and you deserved a better answer than you got on the call, so here it is.

Your questions answered

1 What does Rs. 3.5L actually buy that Coursera does not?

Andrew Ng's courses are genuinely good for concepts -- but they do not interview you, debug your system design at 10pm, or connect you to a hiring manager at a product company. Scaler's structure is built around **live classes 3x a week with industry instructors, 1:1 mentorship with active professionals, and 50+ hands-on projects** -- not video playlists you finish at 0.5x speed and forget. You already proved you can self-study by clearing AWS SA on your own. The question is whether self-study alone will get a TCS SDE-2 past the resume screen at a product company, or whether you need the structured depth, accountability, and the referral weight of **900+ hiring partners** and a **100,000+ alumni network** to actually land the interview.

2 RAG, agents, evals -- is this actually in the program or just marketing?

This is the right question to pressure-test. The curriculum explicitly lists **Prompt Engineering, RAG, and Multi-agent orchestration** under the AI and Agents module, plus an Agentic AI elective -- so it is not buried in a footnote. The program also covers System Design and Backend Architecture, which matters because product companies want engineers who can build and ship LLM applications end-to-end, not just call an API. Curriculum updates are included at no extra cost, so what shipped in 2023 is not what you would study today. For the exact module breakdown and what is live in the current cohort, I would want admissions to walk you through it precisely rather than me guessing release notes -- but the direction is clearly practical, not theoretical.

3 Will you land at a product company or just another service lateral at 16 LPA?

You said it clearly: 14 LPA to 16 LPA at another service company does not justify the risk or the fee, and that is a fair line to draw. I am not going to quote you a personal salary number because your outcome depends on your effort, the roles you target, and the market -- and anyone who gives you a guaranteed figure on a sales call is lying. What I can tell you is that Scaler publishes a **median salary hike of around 110% for the DS/ML track**; whether a comparable figure applies to your profile and the AI engineering roles you are targeting is something admissions can benchmark against people with similar backgrounds. Your 4 years of banking-domain experience at TCS plus an AWS cert is actually a stronger starting point than most switchers -- that context is worth discussing with someone who has seen comparable profiles place.

4 Your next step -- the entrance test

The entrance test is what unlocks your second call with admissions, where you can push on the exact salary benchmarks, the current AI module depth, and EMI options -- all the specifics I want you to get answered properly. Given that you cleared AWS SA independently, the test is not the obstacle here; it is just the gate. Take it, and then go into that second call with the same sharp questions you brought today -- you will get real answers.

TODAY Your current compensation depends on role and city. Happy to personalize on your next call.	TARGET PATH Stronger product and tech-facing roles depend on effort and market. We share realistic bands with admissions, not guesses.
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NOW Skills audit & entrance clarity	0-4 MO Core foundations & habits	4-8 MO Depth projects & design	8-12 MO Interview readiness
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Take the entrance test when you are ready -- it is the one step that gets you from this PDF to a real conversation with actual numbers.